

Mock Interview

TIP101

Agenda

1 Welcome 🙌

2 Mock Interview

3 **BREAK**

4 AI Checkpoint #2

5 Collaborative Problem Solving

6 Wrap Up

10 minutes

35 minutes

5 minutes

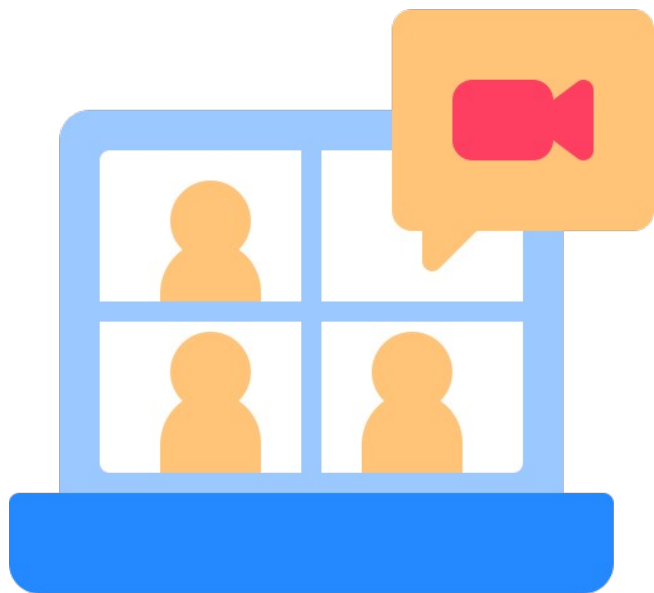
10 minutes

50 minutes

10 minutes

10 minutes

Welcome! 🖐️



**Turn on your
cameras**



**Fill out the entry
ticket**



Icebreaker

5 minutes

🤔 Question:

In the chat, describe your favorite movie or show with 3 words. Let's see who can guess it first!

💬 Answer:

Share your answer in the Zoom chat below. What kinds of pets do you have if any? If you don't have any, share what type you would like to have, if any.

Your Feedback



Glow

- + Felt good about initial linked list lecture!
- + Buddy system going well!
- + Students enjoyed themed practice sets



Grow

- Breakout rooms of size 2 might feel unbalanced.
- Students asked about having test cases provided for the problem sets.



Announcements & Reminders

- * First mock interview today (time to take volunteers)
 - If no volunteers: Special Link 🗨️
- * We will cover more info on the Mock Interview in a few slides, the topic will be Linked Lists!
 - There will be many opportunities, but today we will only ask for one student!
 - Focus is on implementing **UPI** (try to get a good **plan**, you can ask myself or the class for help if you get stuck)
 - Non-volunteers will fill out an observation form.

35 minutes

Mock Interview

Today's Mock Interview

- * I will be the interviewer.
 - As the interviewer, I will simulate a realistic technical interview by asking probing questions and providing minimal hints when necessary.
- * A volunteer student will be the interviewee.
 - As the interviewee, you will think aloud while solving the problem, applying UMPIRE.
- * The rest of the class will observe.
 - [Fill out this form](#) to take notes and provide feedback

Mock Interview Process

1. **Quick intro** (name, school, major)
2. Interviewer **introduces the problem**
3. Candidate **opens link** to problem and **shares screen**
4. Candidate works through the **UPI steps** with interviewer
 - If you need to look something up, it's ok to Google it.
 - Say what you're thinking, what you're doing, and why.
 - Pay attention to feedback and hints from interviewer.
5. After: **Celebrate and recap** what went well!

If you are not the candidate. . .

- * Hold all comments (on mic or in chat) until the end
- * Imagine what you would do in the candidate's shoes
- * Write down and be ready to share:
 - 1 thing the candidate did that you will start doing too!
 - 1 thing you'll do differently now that you've seen this interview.

Evaluation Criteria

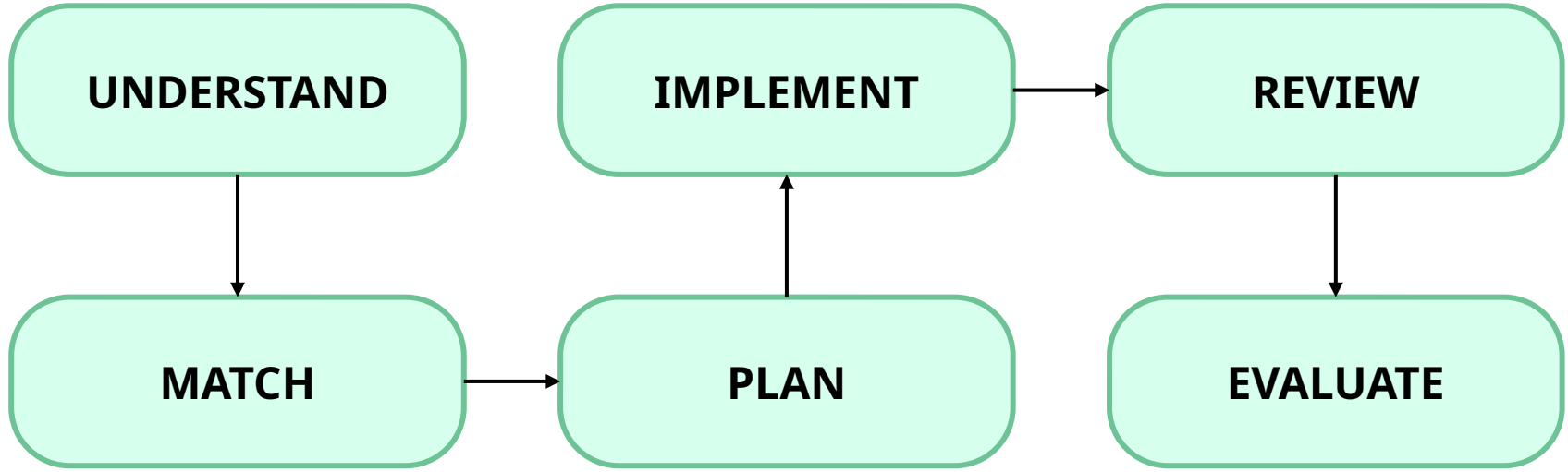
Key Areas of Focus

- * Clarity
- * Problem-solving process
- * Use of the UMPIRE framework

Reminders

- * Prioritize readability and logical flow over rushing to a solution.
- * Communicate effectively throughout to simulate a real-world technical interview scenario.

UMPIRE



Problem

Write a function to remove all duplicate values from a sorted linked list. After removing duplicates, each element in the list should appear only once.

Examples:

* **Input:** head = [1 -> 1 -> 2]

Output: [1 -> 2]

* **Input:** head = [1 -> 1 -> 2 -> 3 -> 3]

Output: [1 -> 2 -> 3]

* **Input:** head = []

Output: []



Discussion

3 minutes

In the chat . . .

What was one thing the candidate did
that you will start doing too?

What is one thing you'll do differently now
that you've seen this interview?



Break Time!

Take 5 mins to step away from the computer. Feel free to turn off your camera and return promptly after 5 mins.



10 minutes

AI Checkpoint #2



Discussion

1-2 minutes

Share an instance in which AI provided
a **wrong answer** 🐞



Why are we discussing this?

* Topic complexity is increasing

- As we get further into the course, the topics stack and become more difficult—requiring mastery of previous units

* We need to ask better questions

- AI will not always understand nuance or vague instructions!



Building our AI prompting skills will make us more successful learners and developers.

AI Prompting Tips



Green Flags

Your prompts should...

- + Explain the context of your question
- + Clearly state the desired response format
- + Help you make design decisions yourself



Red Flags

Avoid prompts that...

- + Paste out-of-context code
- + Make assumptions without stating them
- + Ask the AI to make decisions for you



Discussion

2-3 minutes

How will you write
stronger prompts in
the future?

What **prompt pitfalls**
will you focus on
avoiding?



50 minutes

Collaborative Problem Solving



Breakout Rooms

50 minutes

1. 🏃 Navigate to your breakout room.
2. 🙌 Introduce yourselves!
3. 🧑💻 Work on the problems for your selected unit.

10 minutes

Wrap Up



One Good Thing

Let's reflect on today's session. Maybe you got a question answered, overcame a specific coding challenge, or learned how to do something completely new!

In the chat, share at least one good thing you've learned or experienced during the session today.

Let's celebrate together!



Session Survey Time!





Final Reminders

- ☐ Finish the problem sets for additional practice
- ☐ Take the weekly HackerRank assessment by Sunday @ midnight
- ☐ Visit a **Study Hall Session**
- ☐ Congrats on officially reaching **the halfway point!** Time is flying by and we are improving week by week!
- ☐ CodePath's team is off this Friday for a company holiday
 - weekly submissions are still due!
 - Study hall and tech coach support are still running
 - reach out in the Slack channel or email support@codepath.org if you need help.